

January 2024

06 Saturday

(808 - 360) WK 01

## A-1) Perspective on the Study of Indian Society

1) Indology → Indian Sociology (G.S. Ghurye)

- Continuous society via history (sources)
- Uniqueness of India (like caste system)
- Started as Orientalology (everyone same)
- Western studies in context of India
- 1787: William Jones → Asiatic Society of Bengal
- Emphasis on understanding the society, not reform.

## G.S. Ghurye

- Father of Modern Indology
- Highlight Dynamism of Indian Culture - Uniqueness
- "Called Doyen of Indian Sociology"
- "Nothing disguises the fact that Ghurye was a giant" - MNS

## 3 important aspect

- Own role → 32 book + research
- Initiation → 1952 Bombay University
- Batch of Sociologist → MNS, IK, AR Desai

07 Sunday

## Distinctive approach

- Sanskrit + Vernacular → Local language text (Variations)
- Diffusionist → Cultures affect each other → new culture
- Methodological pluralism → Disciplined eclecticism (diverse)
- Theoretical pluralism → Inductive + Deductive

January

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Monday 08

(808 - 358) WK 02

## 6 Broad area of studies

- Caste: Attributional approach (Feature) + Historical text + Integrative Kin/Caste parallel in some societies + Integrative Framework
- Six structural features
  - Segmental + Hierarchy + Lack of choice of occupation
  - Privilege / Prohibitions + Marriage restriction +
  - Commensality → Food hierarchies
- Endogamy → Hierarchy maintained

## 2) Tribe:

- Studied Mahadev Kolis / General book on STs in India
- Isolation approach → Tribes are sustainable
- Assimilate → to make greater India, Internal cracks
- Already Kindivised (Diffusionist) → Separate (Backward Caste)
- Backwardness → due to imperfect integration into Hindu
- Positive of assimilation → gave up liquor + education + improved agriculture + stops idea of secessionist

## 3) FAMILY AND KINSHIP:

- Endogamy → Created Hierarchy → spine / prohibited degree of kin
- Exogamy → Created Sub Caste → sept / gotra exogamy
- Hypergamy → Sex related endogamy.

January 2024

09 Tuesday

(009 - 357) Wk 02

January

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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#### 4) CIVILISATION AND CULTURE →

Ruralisation → urban life + nature's greenery  
Colonizers → inverted previous pattern  
towns → outlet → transform → manufacturing centre  
Metropolitan economy dominate village economy.

→ Independent Growth of Culture → local needs + situation

Diffusion → new ideas throughout the world

Acculturation → Best of own + best of others

Caste developed by Britain, diffused to others.

Lunch

#### 5) RELEGION →

Centre of cultural heritage + moulds behaviour

Wrote 6 books → Indian Sadhus / Vedic India / Gods and Men

Indian Sadhu → Renunciation (Paradoxical nature)

detached → gain knowledge → lead society / Arbiters

Monastic organisation → product of Hinduism

#### 7) CONFLICT AND INTEGRATION →

History books → social tensions in India + within India +

India resists democracy

5 sources of Dangers → SC + ST + Backward + Muslim + linguistic

Cultural unity → Brahmanical Endeavours, society tensions,  
new ideas accepted by others (one way flow)

Issues from Indology → History of Caste + joint family values +  
Caste were parallel + Ayodhya issue +  
Ram setu explanations.

• Better be three hours soon than one minute late •

January 2024

Wednesday 10

(010 - 356) Wk 02

February

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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#### Criticism of Indology

- Mainly Brahminical point of view (older text) → Sub Altern
- Ignores Tribal History
- Different Indologists give contradictory explanations
- Religious text represent a Value
- Hindu culture as culture of India
- Field study doesn't explain present day situation.

#### Criticism of Ghurye

- Brahminical point of view
- Integration / Assimilation is Value loaded concept
- Armed scholar ethnocentrist (his field works)
- SC / ST / OBC / Muslim presented as threat

#### Indology in Contemporary Times : INDOLOGIST

- Wendy Doniger → Hindus / An Alternative History  
create tension in way how gods are portrayed
- DP Mukherjee → Indology via Marxology  
Karl and Marxism
- Johannes Bronkhorst → Interaction b/w Brahmin / Buddhist &  
Indigenous grammar and linguistics
- William Dalrymple → British Mughal interaction
- AL Basham → Impact of Swami Vivekananda  
"The Wonder that was India"
- RS Sharma → Early Indian social structure, life.  
stress on element of change and continuity

• Better to be harmless, than helpful •



January 2024

11 Thursday

(011 - 355) Wk 02

## A) 1) b) STRUCTURAL FUNCTIONALISM (MN Srinivas)

- Functionalism → Serve purpose + interdependent  
The whole is greater than sum of the parts  
Structure → Human being serve its structure, keep maintained  
Function serve Human being
- Structure Functionalism → study function performed by  
Institution for maintenance of structure.
- Question → Origins? Broader context? part relate to whole?
- AR Radcliffe Brown → totality of social usage  
part work together + Harmony + Conflict regulated.  
change is slow + cumulative process.

Functionalism → field work + Question answers + contextual  
MN Srinivas / SC Durr / McKim Marriott  
WH Wier → Jajmani System → Caste as Harmony/Functional

## 1) MN Srinivas :

- Initiator of structure functionalist analysis in India
- macro sociological generalizations on micro anthropological insights  
Theoretical and Methodological perspective: Coorg river study

Coorgs field study → revealed similarity in rituals  
Functional unity → Interaction in virtual context  
study of caste, religion → Dynamics of caste system

New concept : Dominant caste / Sanskritization / Westernization /  
Secularization to understand inter caste relation

• Blessed are the meek; for they shall inherit the earth •

January 4

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January 2024

Friday 12

(012 - 354) Wk 02

## Social change :

- Brahminization → Sanskritization → Westernization → Secularization  
Level change → Religion (food, diet →) + Secular (class improve)  
Imitate higher class.
- Anticipatory socialization → behaving + inter generation + social mobility  
Study of Rampur → Dominant Caste (Entire group gets mobility)

## RELIGION AND SOCIETY :

- Brahminization → imitating life ways of Brahmin by lower caste  
Sanskritization → imitating higher class  
Book : Social change in Modern India  
Dwijia → twice born caste (Punarjanma) → clean  
Westernization → ideological formulation / cultural innovation

## VILLAGE :

- Village as microcosm of Indian Society.  
Village retain tradition, spread of Hinduism concerned  
most people live in lower caste → low mobility  
Rampur village → Remembered village → Dominating caste

## VIEWS ON CASTE :

- Caste are interdependent + possibility of mobility.  
Modernization as viable paradigms of changes  
caste as segmentary system  
→ segmentary + endogamy → pollution + purity → governing body  
→ common occupation → commensality (caste panchayat)

• Blessed are the merciful, for they shall obtain mercy •

January 2024

13 Saturday

(013 - 353) Wk 02

January

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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| 29 | 30 | 31 |    |    |    |    |

### DOMINANT CASTE :

Rampur → study → peasant (holding land) power > Brahmin  
dominant caste hold power

6 Attributes → Land → High Hierarchy → Jobs / administration  
→ Number → Western education → Urban Source of Ina.  
Numeric strength + Economic ownership + Political strength

### CRITICISM OF MN Srinivas

- Upper caste views (Brahmanic) / More Elitist
- Only Hinduized traditions (view) not secular
- Yogendra Singh → objective idealism  
(pre conceived notion)  
India change in reality fast
- Maitri Chowdhary → Conservative  
No mention of globalization / Feminist
- Anand Chakravarti → No political manipulation mentioned
- Y. Singh → Village no longer microcosm of India
- Gail Omvedt → No neutral sociology  
cannot explain Dalit number + Dominant Hindu
- Yogesh Atal → Dominant caste have different meaning  
Village - Family Dominant  
State - Caste Dominate  
National - Various Dominant caste / Religion

R K Mukherjee → Urban area make policies, village respects

Sub caste / does not explain non-Hindu Mobility

Dipankar Gupta → power faction to overpower dominant caste

January 2024

Monday 15

(015 - 351) Wk 03

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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### CRITICISM OF Structural functionalism -

- Status Avoid → changes are very rapid not slow
- Teleologies → Original reason confuses the change
- Ignore conflicts
- Tendency to generalise → Empirical Anarchism



January 2024

16 Tuesday

(016 - 350) WK 03

January

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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| 29 | 30 | 31 | .  | .  | .  | .  |

## A) 1) C) MARXIST SOCIOLOGY (A R Desai)

Marxist sociology →

10 Radcliffe Brown : History → Sociology

Wilhelm Windenrd : History ideographic (facts)

11 Hermann Rickert : Socio Nomothetic (Abstractions, Generalization)

12 Marx → Society subject matter of History

Complementary + Interdependent

13 { Dialectics → check in History, Thesis and Anti thesis  
Historical materialism → development and evolution, data  
Economics → Centre stage, affect all }

14 Daniel Thorner → Agrarian class structure

15 Kathleen Gough → class caste nexus with industry/economy

IP Desai → joint family in agrarian → Dol + Economy

16 Berman → Jajmani exploitative for Kamins

17 A R Desai

Reject Uniqueness of Indian Culture (Generalization)

18 Study Indian History using economic perspective

19 Worked under GS Ghurye

Book - The Social Background of Indian Nationalism

20 fresh view on India level problems

7 idea → Bourgeoisie Constitution → Religious state

Contemporary → Bourgeoisie Culture → False development

→ Crisis deepen → Capitalism not answer

→ Only Socialism can end crisis

• Can you ask price for you ghee before buying buffalo? •

January 2024

Wednesday 17

(017 - 349) WK 03

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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## ON BIRTH OF CASTE -

• Aryan invasion → destroyed Indian Mode of production

Aryan superior caste, Indigenous → separate residence

Occupation rigidified by Brahmins

10 Cultural reproduction → system established

## ON BUDDHISM / JAINISM -

Patronizing → ruler need religion approval

12 Lower caste ruler → against Brahmanic → new Religion promoted

Hinduism want to coopt Buddhism → concept of Avatar

## CLASSES IN INDIA -

13 Masters (Haves), Service (Haves not)

Service class → Morally + Socially bounded to serve

## FEUDALISM IN INDIA -

15 Indian feudalism come from above, King created land owner  
different from European feudalism

16 Normal people → no land, no ownership, services as tax

17 Capitalistic Map → by colonialism → 1857 revolt  
(feudalism vs Capitalism (mixing))

## INDIAN NATIONAL MOVEMENT -

19 Feudal lords → into industry under British

Emergent industrialist / Middle class → risk to get power

20 Guided Idea of Nation → to create revolt → get position

Democracy come without → Democratic participation x

Economic freedom x, Political freedom x

• Can you paint the outer wall neglecting the inner wall •

January 2024

18 Thursday

(018 - 348) Wk 03

| January | Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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January 2024

Friday 19

(019 - 347) Wk 03

### CONTEMPORARY POLICIES -

Sceptical → false consciousness, no real development  
conscious design of dominant group to  
glorify the segmentation

### CONCLUSION -

- Desai attempt to understand poverty + illiteracy + backwardness + marginalization of masses
- INM, Development → populist measure to ensure True class consciousness / Polarisation

### CRITICISM -

- Andre Beteille → Exaggeration of eco-history, caste ignored  
development is true, cannot be ignored
- Y Singh → Highly sceptical of everything  
Country sign of democracy → Peasant + farmer
- Gail Omvedt → See only 2 polarized class, India has spectrum  
Delit are immensely suppressed
- Jyoti Basu → Marxist ignore caste and religion  
Middle class rise → contrary to Marxist

- ANAND CHAKRAVARTY : Hegemonistic Domination  
against class domination, underclass subjected to  
various form of deprivation.
- Urban Intelligentsia → bring support + Human rights

### ANARJEET GUHA : Subaltern Sociology

- History from view of mass perspective instead of ruler view
- Whose true voice (Subaltern studies)
- Ex tribal movement, caste movement, peasant movement
- Subaltern groups have exhibited resistance in diff parts
- Post colonial studies + critical theory + study excluded

Antonio Gramsci : Subaltern meaning 'of inferior rank'  
Cultural Hegemony → excludes, displaces specific people  
study group in society subjected to Hegemony of ruling class  
difficult to study → denied access.  
Wrote against "Cambridge school" ↔ against colonial legacies

Relevance : tremendous political repercussions  
Great Britain : Commonwealth idea ↔ yet uses racism  
cover histories + ignored events + show hidden secrets

Ranajit Guha → focus on tribal + peasant movement  
Emphasis on role of Individual leader or organization  
Analyzed binary relation b/w Subaltern + Ruling class  
Argues Indian Nationalism was dominated by elites

### Criticism

- Dipesh Chakrabarty → impossible to break from Western narrative
- Virek Chibber → Obfuscation of class struggle → confusion
- Gayatri Chakravorty → Subaltern cannot speak  
working class is oppressed but not subaltern

'Learning to learn from below'



January 2024

20 Saturday

(020 - 346) WK 03

January

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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| 29 | 30 | 31 |    |    |    |    |

Study Indian culture in 4 aspects

- Hierarchy → gradation of people
- Transcendence → Karma, religion
- Materialism → Broader level connection
- Continuity → of culture, thought, karma etc

21 Sunday

• Clear statement is argument •

January 2024

Monday 22

(022 - 344) WK 04

February

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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• Clever men are good, but they are not the best •

January 2024

23 Tuesday

(023 - 343) Wk 04

January

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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## A2) IMPACT OF COLONIAL RULE ON INDIAN SOCIETY

### a) Social background of Indian Nationalism

#### Perspective of Nationalist -

- Nation always existed, Urban Middle class seeking reform
- Western educated → seeking reform in social institution
- Promoted by Ronade, Pt Nehru, NK Dutt, KN Panikkar
- Promote territorial integration + stimulate mass mind

#### Perspective of Marxist - (AR Desai)

- Mode of Production influence political superstructure
- Nationalism was meant to get power by middle class families

#### Indian Nationalism in 5 different phases

- Prior to British : Nationalism absent, village autonomy never touched
- 1800-1850 : British education and policies, tax collector, police
- Peasant suppression → Rise of Intelligentsia
- 1850-1888 : Destruction of Indigenous industry
- Revolt of 1857 → Peasant dethroned feudal lords
- Colonial power consolidate → British good → Debt trap + poverty
- 1888-1905 : Indian Bourgeoisie encouraged middle class to protest
- 80% of goods are British, 12 Industry remained
- Indian National Congress started
- 1905-1920 : Mobilisation of Peasant, Rise of Kisan Sabha
- 1920-1940 : Gandhi bridged gap b/w classes Synthesis together
- Bourgeois interest got glorified in INC

• Coming events cast their shadows before •

January 2024

Wednesday 24

(024 - 342) Wk 04

February

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### Criticism / Reaction →

- A. Beteille → India needs concern about Social Equity / old not required.
- Ramchandra Guha → Gandhi was statesman, understood masses
- Y Singh → This is ideology not reality
- A Beteille → Focused empiricism to fit Marxist ideology
- MN Srinivas → Diversity of India is balancing force.
- Lack of Empirical data → Anecdotal evidence.

### Relevance Today →

- Sub Nationalism → separatist movement
- Hindu Nationalism → new challenge to secular state
- Nationalism → pathological + promote unity + Science + Cosmes.

### Important part of SBIN

- Women / Caste / Tribal / Urban Rural
- Religion → led to partition
- Role of Diaspora.

• Common sense is not so common •



January 2024

25 Thursday

(025 - 341) WK 04

## A2 b) Modernisation of Indian Tradition -

### Modernity →

Parson ADAPCO → features of modern world

Ascription → Achievement      Diffusion → specificity  
Affectivity → Neutrality      Particularism → Universalism  
Collective Orientation → Individual Orientation

change in norms, ethos, values, culture, structure

Weber → historic process, rooted to Renaissance

Simmel → 19th century product → Secular + Industry + Bureaucracy

### 14 Nationalist perspective: Ghose / Mukherjee / RN Sharma

Modernity as instrument of development

15 Sceptical about colonial attempt, British is grid oriented

Vivekananda - Synthesis of Materialism + Spiritualism

16 Preserving uniqueness of India and its tradition

### 17 Marxist perspective:

DR Mukherjee → growth of middle class, wanted work and MOP 26 Friday

18 AR Datta → Modernity is colonial construct, destroyed Indigenous  
Segmentary interest of class, no collective interest

### 19 Marxist and Milton Singer:

20 Concluded → Indianisation of modern tradition rather than  
modernisation of Indian tradition

Orthogenic → Indigenous change (from within)

Heterogenic → Imported or because of other tradition

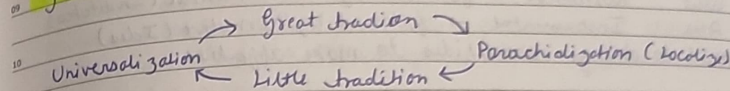
January 2024

Saturday 27

(027 - 339) WK 04

Little tradition → Localised, known to less, folk / peasant

Great tradition → Elites, reflective few, big books / rules



Parochialisation → some element circulate down, new tradition emerge

Universalisation → element become great tradition, food + festival

Contemporary → Globalisation + Glocalisation + Migration + IT

### Milton Singer conclusion

- Interaction reflected big tradition and little tradition.
- Create common cultural consciousness
- creation of process like sacred books + rituals etc
- helps in cultural continuity in face of modernisation.

### Criticism

SC Dubey → not always synchronic, modernity absolutely influence  
tradition, Brahminical tradition disintegrating

### MN Srinivas Perspective -

Orthogenic - Sanskritisation, Heterogenic - Westernisation

Modernity is value loaded - not always good

Westernisation - only copy lost in modernisation

Can co-exist with democracy

January 2024

29 Monday

(029 - 337) WK 05

January

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## Gusman Myrdal's Perspective →

Distinction b/w modernity in West and Asia

West : Normative → followed by Instrumental (Institutes)

Asia : Instrumental → followed by Normative (Ideas)

need to change norms/ideas to make effective

## Louis Dumont : Cognitive Theory →

India is a classic example of hierarchy, modernity not acceptable.

Social distance ↔ homo hierarchicus ↔ stand in way of modernity

West are → homo equillous → promote equality.

## Andre Beteille Criticism →

change derived by internal (hierarchical) and external (equillous)

India is not central culture → prone to change

High adaptability + different at different places

## Yogendra Singh : Modernisation of Indian Tradition →

Critics all approach → Precision + Objectivity + Integration  
tried to combine all theories.

| Source of Change                | Cultural Structure                     |                                                      | Social Structure                                                      |                                                                              |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                 | Little tradition                       | Great Tradition                                      | Micro Structure                                                       | Macro structure                                                              |
| Heterogeneous Changes (Outside) | Islamisation<br>Primary Westernisation | Secondary Islamic Impact<br>Secondary Westernisation | Role JE → NE<br>Differentiation<br>New (caste)<br>Legitimation        | Political Innovation<br>Elites, Bureaucrats<br>Industries                    |
| Orthogenic Changes (Inside)     | Sanskritisation<br>Traditionisation    | Cultural Renaissance                                 | Pattern Recurrence<br>Compulsive Migration<br>pop. shift (demography) | Elite circulation<br>Succession of King,<br>Rise of cities,<br>Trade centres |

• Constancy is the foundation of virtues •

January 2024

Tuesday 30

(030 - 336) WK 05

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| 29 | 30 | 31 |    |    |    |    |

## Conflict b/w 2 Great Tradition → Rise of Islam with Hinduism

Islam started conversion → paradoxically → led to change in Islam

Appearance of caste in Islam

Divide created → delimited into separation of 2 Nation

Similarity in SE Asia → Milder type of Islam → Influence of Buddhism

## Heterogenic changes - PESTL Analysis

PESTL modernity leads to value modernity (achievement based)

Different people adopting changes differently according to their needs

## Criticism of Y Singh

Irfan Ahmad → Integrated existing framework, not his own

Antagonising toward Islam and Muslims

Treat Muslims alien to India

## Even impacted others

SC Dubey → Called Islamic invaders

Irfan Karve → Muslim so external and inimical.

JPS Oberoi → Indian and Western modernity is same

## Hinderance to modernisation

Religion believe (Karma theory) / Elites

Y Singh → Status Quo orientation / Caste divide / Joint family / Orthodox superstition

## Post Modernist Theory

Avijit Pathak → Modernity is universal pattern, economic growth  
caste reinforcement → Endogamy getting supported from IT revolution

Griddens → High modernity (several instruments)

• Constant practice often excels even talent •



January 2024

31 Wednesday

(031 - 335) Wk 05

January

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
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| 22 | 23 | 24 | 25 | 26 | 27 | 28 |
| 29 | 30 | 31 |    |    |    |    |

## 92 c) Protest and Movement during the colonial period

- 10 British Missionary → started spreading Christianity.  
attacking caste, custom, creeds and practices
- 11 Propaganda → to create Hegemony, Christianity > Hinduism
- Value loaded → Spirit of Inquiry + English education
- 12 advocated western thought

- 13 Reformers → Hindu societies had rotten
- Revivalist → plead for reform on national line, glorious past

Lunch

### Cause led to movements

- 14 → Women Condition → Position of women
- Lack of Education → Ignorance of backward people
- 15 → Extremely dehumanized and marginalized people.
- 16 Arya Samaj → self reform of Hinduism
- Mahatma Gandhi → Campaign against untouchability
- 17 Swami Vivekanand → Ramakrishna Mission → Enlightenment ideas

### 18 Impact of Movement

- Socio religious consciousness → National movement → freedom Struggle
- 19 Self respect + self confidence + pride in country
- Identity as Indian
- 20 Attacked bigotry, superstition and hold of priestly class

Evening Limitation: affected small percentage of population  
could not reach peasantry and poor people

• Towards die many times before their deaths •

February 2024

Thursday 01

(032 - 334) Wk 05

February

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  |    |    |    |
| 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  | 10 | 11 |
| 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 |
| 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 | 25 |
| 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 |    |    |    |

## BRAMHO SAMAJ -

1828 - founded by Raja Rammohan Roy

- Emphasized human problem must be solved in human ways  
stepping inhuman practices, faith in one God.
- 10 promote unity and tolerance among various religion.

## ARYA SAMAJ -

1875 - founded by Swami Dayanand Saraswati

- 12 Aim to reform Hindu religion, Vedas to be infallible
- Falshood of other religion, purity and science of Vedas
- 13 Condemned idol-worship, animal sacrifices, pilgrimages,  
caste system, child marriage etc.

Lunch

major role in promoting education and national movement

14 Criticism → lack universal vision, success among orthodox.

• Creation is a drug I can't do without •

February 2024

02 Friday

(033 - 333) Wk 05

February

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| .  | .  | .  | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  |
| 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  | 10 | 11 |
| 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 |
| 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 | 25 |
| 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 | .  | .  | .  |

| Mo | Tu | We | Th | Fr | Sa | Su |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| .  | .  | .  | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  |
| 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  | 10 | 11 |
| 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 |
| 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 | 25 |
| 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 | 30 | 31 | .  |

Saturday 03

(034 - 332) Wk 05

## A2 d) Social Reforms

### Tribal Protest

- Sanyasi Santhal → Mundu
- Ho → Pagar Ponhi etc
- Khazi

### Agrarian Unrest

- Indigo → Patna → Kheda etc
- Deccan → Champaran

### Characteristics of Protest

- Localised → Never directly challenged Britishers
- Against Zamindar → Exposure to the world

### Consequences of Protest

- AR Desai : Freedom movement was not possible without
- Y Singh : role in transforming traditional to modern
- TN Madan : Indianised the modernity
- MSA Rao : Cultural Pride + Unified people

04 Sunday

• Death of snake charmer would be caused by his snake •

• Custom reconciles us to everything •